

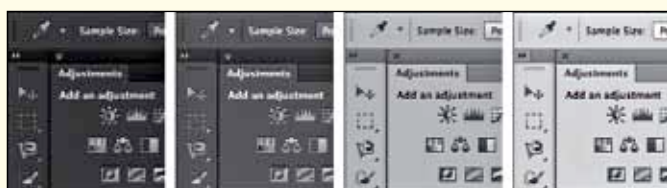
You can set the interval after which Photoshop automatically saves your file

darker interface. This is purportedly in place for a more immersive experience, though the purists who vouch for the original grey-colored interface can always return to the original one, by going to **Edit > Preferences**. Photoshop calls the interface colours **Brightness Options**. It has four different brightness user interfaces available. One noticeable and welcomed improvement is the draggable section of all toolbars for easy movement around the windows. Managing the screen real estate was never a strong point for Photoshop but CS6 makes it easier to move toolbars around, with the window glowing blue when you bring a toolbar near it.

Photoshop to save the file. If the file was large, you could easily have time for a cup of coffee or a stroll around the office. But this isn't the case with CS6; the saving process takes place in the background, so you don't need to spend your time fooling around when your Photoshop is saving the file. One thing to keep in mind though: only the changes made till the point you hit save are stored by this mechanism. The changes made after this point aren't saved – no auto-saves.

Automatic recovery

You feel like ripping your hair out when Photoshop crashes on a file you've been working on for



Choose anything between the new 'dark' UI or the original grey UI

There's this one small change that some of the pro users who've been working with Photoshop for years may find irksome. Tools like "crop" and "lasso" now have small cursors at the top. In the previous versions, you had to use the bottom of the lasso to mark a section but now you have to use the tip of the cursor as your guide. Additionally, though not all of the tools behave in the same way, an eyedropper still behaves as an eyedropper.

Background saving

In previous versions, hitting [Ctrl]+[S] would mean that you couldn't do anything else for the amount of time it would take

hours and the worst part is that you haven't saved it! Photoshop CS6 introduces automatic recovery, which automatically saves a file as you work. You can set the interval after which Photoshop automatically saves the file, and thus you'll never be more than 10 minutes away from the last change that you made. Go ahead and test this feature with a dummy PS file.

Content-aware Move and Extend

These are two of the more heavily touted features. The "Content-aware" tool lets you select a car parked on a street in a picture and move it from one end of the street to another end, with Photoshop filling in

the space previously occupied by the car based on the context i.e. the object around it. It also applies a feather to your selection where you've placed the object you just moved. The effectiveness of this tool though is still under question. It's in no way perfect, and a complex image with multiple objects gives disastrous results. The entire exercise with the "Content-aware" tools feels a bit gimmicky; they merely seem to be in place to entice new users with cleverly developed but poorly performing tools.

Another tool from the content-aware stable is 'content-aware extend', which can be used to scale geometric objects like flagpoles and skyscrapers but it doesn't perform as well on non-geometric shapes such as the human body.

Blur gallery

The Blur gallery will have photography enthusiasts dancing around in glee. It features three filters – Tilt Shift, Iris and Field

blur filters. Previously, you'd have to use actions or follow detailed tutorials to get these effects but these filters, integrated inside Photoshop, help achieve the precise effect. The simplest among the three is the Field Blur but it offers the least amount of direct control. The Iris Blur filter gives you much more rounded and comprehensive control over the location and intensity of the blur

effect. Though it looks simple, this effect is quite powerful and flexible. The Tilt Shift effect is used to conjure an appearance of miniaturisation. It actually emulates the optical effects of extreme perspective control lenses. This particular filter offers excellent control over the effect to get the desired results.

Photographers rely on focal length, subject distance and aperture to determine in-focus and blurred areas of an image. But with such powerful tools in hand, it'll be difficult to



The simple yet powerful field blur

tell an actual photo and a photoshopped image apart.

Crop tool

The new crop tool will harangue a lot of users. It takes everything backwards. The new crop tool functions in the opposite way to how it used to. The cropped canvas will stay parallel to your display and the actual image will move around, rotate and scale according to your com-



Content-aware Move in action